

FATE OF THE PUMA

Eternal Recurrence

Written by

LMB

FADE IN:

INT. HOME THEATER

A grey-haired man, GEORGE HARRISON (50's), and a young woman, ERIN DAWES (late 20's), sit in the middle of an home theater.

GEORGE
Has it really been that long?

ERIN
It has.

GEORGE
He's going to hate this.

ERIN
I know.

Erin presses a button on a remote.

WE MOVE into a reportage titled "FATE OF THE PUMA".

ERIN (V.O) (CONT'D)
It has been ten years since the
rumors first started.

We see an AEREIL VIEW of the METROPOLIS of DERRY CITY.
Skyscrapers, trains, trams, an insane amount of cars, cabs
and most of all PEOPLE. A LOT OF PEOPLE.

ERIN (V.O.) (CONT'D)
A mythological beast, body of a
man, head of a Puma. A modern day
Minotaur. Derry City, his
labyrinth. The worst of us, our
sacrifices to satiate him.

We see mugshots of multiple beaten up criminals.

Captions show the crimes under each person as they pass, the
worse the offense, the worse the degree of battery.

ERIN (V.O.) (CONT'D)
From aggravated assault, to
domestic violence. From grand theft
auto, to homicide. And double
homicide. And triple homicide.

As Erin spells out triple homicide, a COMPLETELY BATTERED
man appears on screen.

ERIN (V.O) (CONT'D)
It took a couple of years before a
clear image of "The Puma" could be
captured.

A picture of a bloody, shredded man wearing with the HEAD OF
AN ORANGE PUMA in a DARK ALLEY appears.

ERIN (V.O.) (CONT'D)
While the people were waiting to
see him, they surely had heard him.
Loud and clear.

A series a street interviews plays.

INTERVIEWEE #1
The growl.

INTERVIEWEE #2
The growl.

INTERVIEWEE #3
That BLEEP growl.

INTERVIEWEE #1
It's something out of this world.

INTERVIEWEE #3
It's not an animal. I know animals,
that ain't that.

INTERVIEWEE #2
It vibrates in your soul.

ERIN (V.O.)
The beast's call that became known
Growl That Rocked The World after
the Copper Bridge Rampage.

Various angles of NEWS FEED covering The Puma battling a
PURPLE THREE-HEADED 8-FOOT-MONSTER.

ERIN (V.O) (CONT'D)
After a strenuous fight, The Puma
eventually took down the monster
folkloristically referred to as The
Hydra.

Footage shows The Puma climbing the Copper Bridge and
DROPPING on the back of The Hydra holding a METAL ROPE.

The Puma forcefully wraps the cord around all three heads,
before choking it, WHILE EMITTING AN EARTH SHATTERING GROWL.

The Hydra drops DEATH, almost COLLAPSING the whole bridge.

OVERLAP as the CAMERA from a CHOPPER pushes in on the torn mask of The Puma, showing glimpses of the MAN behind it.

JACK (OVERLAP)
That was the beginning of it.

TAG: Lieutenant Jack DiAngelo, DCPD

The Lieutenant is being interviewed in front of a large window above Derry City.

JACK (CONT'D)
We had never seen anything like that before. These- how can I say- larger-than-life threats only appeared when this larger-than-life vigilante appeared.

ERIN (O.C.)
You say vigilante, some would say hero.

JACK
I don't think he is a hero. I'm not a man of faith, Ms. Dawes, but I am a man of beliefs and I do believe this- this Puma is a curse for this city.

ERIN (O.C.)
What do you mean by that?

JACK
All these tragedies, all the dead, all the ones that he saved- none of that would have ever happened if he had stayed wherever he was. Don't you agree? He is been gone a year and nothing has happened, nothing like what happened last year. Maybe it's finally over, maybe Dr. Rain broke the curse.

INTERCUT with footage of The Puma fighting various super-rogues, saving people from collapsing buildings, but also destruction and death plays...

INTERVIEWEE #1
He saved this city because he is the only one who can save it.

INTERVIEWEE #3

I don't know if he is a curse. What has this city done to deserve one?

INTERVIEWEE #2

All I know I have been getting the best sleep of the past ten years since he's been gone.

Intercut STOPS on a frame of The Puma GROWLING to the sky in the middle of a destroyed Derry Square (Time Square for reference).

ERIN (V.O)

Maybe that is the case. Maybe the incident with Dr. Rain was the last straw. Maybe that was too much even for him.

Archival footage of DR. ALEXANDER RAIN plays.

ERIN (V.O.) (CONT'D)

Once a well-respected socialite and high-profile member of the Derry community, founder of the Rain Foundation For Derry- the non-profit organization responsible for the creation of a series of social programs for people in need- Dr. Rain's reputation was completely shattered last year, when an undercover investigation conducted by DCPD revealed RainCo disturbing secrets.

POLICE BODYCAM FOOTAGE:

Guns in hand, flashlights in the other, two police officers advance in the dark.

OFFICER #1

Entering RainCo Labs. Reports indicate-

A loud ACUTE SCREAM is heard.

OFFICER #2

What the BLEEP was that?

Officer #1 turns. A FACELESS figure ATTACKS him, ending the footage.

Footage of EXPERIMENTS ON LIVE HUMANS plays, blurred to cover the patients.

ERIN (V.O.)
RainCo was discovered to be
developing, under direct
supervision of Dr. Rain, an
abhorrent technique aimed at
transforming humans in faceless,
emotionless, murder weapons for a
still unknown client.

Dr. Rain appears, speaking directly into camera.

Eyes crazed, malicious grin.

DR. RAIN
Here is what is going to happen.
You are going to let me go. You are
going to let me disappear and you
are not going to follow me, because
if you do, if you dare to step a
single foot behind me, I WILL
inject the compound in Derry's
public water supply. I am going to
KILL everybody. My life is done
already, might as well take
everybody else with me. No?

NEWS REEL footage.

An island off the coast of Derry.

A single bridge connecting it to the city.

A large grey compound on it, armed men to defend it, a
helicopter on top.

Choppers, police boats, police cars surrounding it.

TAGLINE: "Militia led by Dr. Alexander Rain takes over
central water supply system".

ERIN (V.O.)
The Puma went in.

News reel footage shows The Puma charging the structure in a
loud growl.

ERIN (V.O.) (CONT'D)
He never came out. No one did.

Erin appears in front of the camera.

ERIN (CONT'D)

There is footage of what the police eventually found when they went in- twenty-four hours after the Puma had entered- but I do not think there would be any journalistic value in showing it. Thirty-five people were working at the water supply system when Dr. Rain and his twenty-men militia took it.

(a beat)

They all died. Fifty-five people. Some reduced so badly they would not have been recognizable if it weren't for name tags. On the other hand, The Puma and Dr. Rain were never found. While we have an idea of what happened to Dr. Rain-

She PULLS UP a note, kept in a glass container, saying:

Dr. Alexander Rain is no longer

My condolences to the family.

The Puma

ERIN (CONT'D)

-A question remains unanswered.

(a beat)

What was the fate of The Puma?

OPENING CREDITS: "FATE OF THE PUMA - ETERNAL RECURRENCE".

ESTABLISHING: DERRY CITY SKYLINE - NIGHT

ESTABLISHING: EXT. RAIN PENTHOUSE - CONTINUOUS

INT. RAIN PENTHOUSE - CONTINUOUS

The luxurious Rain Family penthouse is crawling with elegantly dressed ladies and gentlemen.

Waiters and waitresses in finely cut suits swiftly wriggle amongst guests carrying trays of hors d'oeuvres and champagne.

BANNERS above them neatly recite "RFFD: JOHNSON FOR MAYOR".

TIN TIN TIN.

GEORGE has taken center stage on the little podium built in the middle of the main living area.

The lights are classily toned down. A spotlight appears over George.

GEORGE
Ladies and Gentlemen, your future
mayor, Ms. Henriette Johnson.

George extends his hand to the left, where the spotlight PICKS UP Henriette Johnson (50/60's).

Henriette shakes George's hand as thunderous applause welcomes her to the stage.

HENRIETTE
(in George's hear)
Where is he?

GEORGE
(pretending to smile,
low)
Somewhere here, I'm sure.

HENRIETTE
(matching George)
You better find him.

George salutes the crowd and heads off stage.

We STAY on George as he walks down the stairs.

HENRIETTE (O.C.) (CONT'D)
Thank you, George! And thank you!!!
Thank you all!

Right down the stairs, George is met by ERIN.

GEORGE
Have you seen him, Erin?

ERIN
Yep.

GEORGE
Is he here?

HENRIETTE (O.C.)
Thank you all for being here. It's
an honor and a pleasure-

ERIN
Nope.

HENRIETTE (O.C.)
 -to be standing in front of you as
 your mayoral candidate. As you
 know, you are all here-

GEORGE
 Fuck.

HENRIETTE
 -not only as concerned citizens of
 Derry, but also as trusted and
 valued members and donors of the
 Rain Foundation For Derry. For this
 reason, I would like to take this
 opportunity to thank our patron, as
 well as head of RFFD-

Henriette turns to George.

George signals "NO".

HENRIETTE (CONT'D)
 -Josh Rein, who unfortunately could
 not join us due to prior
 engagements.

GEORGE
 Where is he?

HENRIETTE (O.C.)
 The Rain family and their
 foundation have been a staple of
 this city for centuries-

Erin BARELY points above Henriette.

CAMERA CATCHES and FOLLOWS the point to an inclined MIRROR
 CEILING above all the guests.

HENRIETTE (O.C.) (CONT'D)
 -making the overwhelming support I
 have received from The Foundation a
 constant reminder of how important
 a mission I have embarked on.

As applause emerges again, CAMERA pushes in on the mirror,
 SLIDING THROUGH IT, to...

INT. RAIN PENTHOUSE - FAMILY QUARTERS - LATER

The mirror ceiling is revealed to be a ONE-WAY MIRROR,
 behind which, in front of a SPACIOUS LUXURIOUS LIVING ROOM,
 stands JOSH REIN (30's), standing above his guests,
 attentively observing them.

The ELEVATOR behind him chirps, MOVING his attention.

ERIN exits the elevator.

ERIN
You know George is going to kill
you, right?

JOSH
Erin, I said I would be here and
here I am.

ERIN
You said you would be down there,
not here.

JOSH
I never said such a thing.

ERIN
That's now what George said.

JOSH
Then George is lying.

ERIN
I'm sorry?

JOSH
I mean- he misunderstood.

ERIN
Sure he did.

Josh extends his hand to the crowd beneath him.

JOSH
No one cares whether I'm there or
not. They hare having fun.

ERIN
I know they are.

JOSH
Then why you bother?

ERIN
Bother? In the sense of bothering
you?

JOSH
That's not what I said.

ERIN

Why are you bothering with this shit? You have barely left this place in the past year and now all of a sudden you have decided to take an interest in the fate of Derry's mayoral seat?

JOSH

I like her.

ERIN

You spent two hundred and fifty grands in the past three months on this campaigns.

JOSH

What's your source on that?

ERIN

I can't reveal my sources, it's deontologically foul.

JOSH

It's George, right?

ERIN

I am not saying.

JOSH

I like her.

ERIN

One-million-dollars-a-year like her?

JOSH

Maybe more.

ERIN

I think you have run out of toys to play with up here.

JOSH

Maybe I have.

ERIN

Then maybe you should get that mask back on.

JOSH

Your boyfriend would disagree.

ERIN
You've heard, then.

JOSH
Who hasn't? That's all he talks about in every fucking interview he gives. By the way- he has been giving a lot of those recently, is he *actually* going for Commissioner? I hear he's been trying to get in Henri's good graces lately.

ERIN
You sure know a lot about what's happening down there for a man that spends his life five-hundred-feet in the air.

JOSH
We have TVs up here.

Erin smiles, tenderly.

ERIN
When is this reclusion going to end?

JOSH
It's not reclusion, it's-

ERIN
Preservation.

Erin goes for the elevator, calls it.

ERIN (CONT'D)
Since you do have TVs up here, I guess you have heard what's happening with those kids. Dressing up like you. Trying to be you.

JOSH
They are not trying to be Josh Rain.

ERIN
That's not what I meant.

JOSH
That's who I am.

ERIN

That's what you are choosing to be.
Are you ever going to tell me what
happened that day?

The elevator arrives, Erin steps in.

JOSH

I can't.
(a beat)
It's nice to-

ERIN

I can't even begin to explain how
sorry I am for what happened with
your father. I can't understand and
I don't want to an extent, but you
can't close yourself up here and
expect the problems of the world to
just disappear.

JOSH

What if that's exactly how they
disappear?

The elevator doors begin to close, Josh puts his hand
through to stop them.

Josh opens his mouth, trying to say something, but the words
die on his lips.

Erin shakes her head, pushes his hand behind and presses the
closing door button.

ERIN

Jake says someone is setting up
those kids, The Copycat Pumas they
call them. They can't find who.

The doors close, elevator goes, Josh, left alone, goes back
to his one-way-mirror.

INT. ABANDONED BUILDING - SAME NIGHT

FIVE BRUISED, BATTERED and most of all TERRIFIED teenagers
are knelt down and chained to the wall behind them.

Plastic Puma masks hang above them.

A MAN in a WHITE SUIT holding a SPIKED baseball bat walks
ahead into FRAME, shoulder to the CAMERA.

The man walks to the teenager in the middle of the row and
lifts his head from the chin with the bat.

TEENAGER #1

Please...

BATTER

You need not be scared, child. It's all over now.

TEENAGER #2

HE IS COMING FOR US!

The batter SHATTERS the spikes over the kid's cheek, dropping him in a pool of blood.

BATTER

Very poor choice of words. The education system is really not what it used to be anymore.

The batter EXTRACTS the bat from the poor kids face and cleans the blood over his white pants.

BATTER (CONT'D)

They say imitation is the highest form of flattery, yet I don't understand why you would want to flatter such a monster. A ruthless creature, an abomination of nature. Not a man. Not an animal. A bloodthirsty reject of society. Why would you do that? Why would you do that to yourself?

The Batter stops. Looks down at the teenager in the middle.

BATTER (CONT'D)

Are you going to answer that?

The teenager shakes his head. The batter SMASHES the middle of his head.

Batter removes his club from the kid's head and cleans it on his other leg.

BATTER (CONT'D)

Fucking hell. What is wrong with you kids now a days?

The Batter shakes his head, genuinely disappointed.

BATTER (CONT'D)

When I was a kid- much younger than you are now- I was thought that one is to ANSWER when an adult- or person of higher authority- asks a QUESTION.

He points the bat at one of the remaining kids.

BATTER (CONT'D)

But you don't give a shit? Do you? You just want to be like him. You want to be The Puma. The goddamn fucking Puma.

(a beat)

Well you are not. And you can't. Because you could never do *this* to me.

CAMERA finds The Batter's face.

A painting of scars and open cuts where the eyes barely find a place to exist.

The Batter brings the bat to his face. Opens a scar, blood GUSHES OUT immediately.

BATTER (CONT'D)

This is who you are trying to flatter.

The Batter SMASHES the five hanging masks in one hit, then...

POV: the teenagers, shaking, looking up at The Batter pacing in front of them.

BATTER (CONT'D)

Who's going first boys?

POV: the teenagers, The Batter paces. Then stops. Looks down. Grins. His club hits.

Dark.

INT. CENTRAL WATER SUPPLY - A YEAR BEFORE

All the alarm systems BLAST in unison.

DR. ALEXANDER RAIN (or what is left of him) stands crouched in middle of an insane PILE OF BODIES.

His eyes are FULLY gone, SMOOTH SKIN in their place.

DR. RAIN
THIS THE COMPENSATION I GET FOR ALL
MY GOOD WILL! AFTER ALL I HAVE DONE
FOR THIS CITY! ALL THE MONEY I
THREW AWAY FOR THEM! TO KEEP THEM
HAPPY! TO KEEP THEM QUIET! TO KEEP
THEM ALIVE IN THE DISGUSTING FILTH
OF A LIFE THEY CONDUCT AND THIS IS
HOW THEY REPAY ME! AAAAAAA!

Dr. Rain JUMPS TOWARDS THE CAMERA...

INT. RAIN PENTHOUSE - BEDROOM - NIGHT

Josh wakes up in a puddle of sweat, he gets out of bed and walks to the window.

He looks down at the city.

Five-hundred feet in the air.

THE PIER - DAY

Police officers keep PRESS and CITIZENS alike away.

JACK DIANGELO observes the ROPE connecting "The Hail Mary" to Sasha "The Batter" Ravinov's feet.

Jack stands to the back of Ravinov, his once white suit now almost entirely red.

JACK
Scully! Bring me gloves!

ANDREA SCULLY (early 20's), apprentice with the Derry City Police Department, runs over to Jack holding a pair of gloves.

JACK (CONT'D)
Please record the examination.

SCULLY
Yes sir.

Scully extracts her tape recorder from her pocket.

Jack turns the body to his face.

The Batter's face is pale, yet the scratches and blows still almost pulsate.

JACK

Begin first on site inspection.
Medics yet to appear on site,
autopsy to be expected within the
day.

Jack walks around the body, examining the bruises and blood sprouts.

JACK (CONT'D)

Body appears to have been beaten to
death. Scratches on the body
resembles those attributable to the
vigilante once known as The Puma.
(a beat)
Are you recoding?

SCULLY

Yes sir.

Jack turns the body to his face, lowers to it.

The bottom lip looks freakishly more swollen compared to the upper.

JACK

Examining face of the victim.
Bottom lip significantly more
swollen than upper.

Jack LOWERS the bottom lip.

JACK (CONT'D)

There appears to be a large scar on
the inside of the lip.
(to Scully)
Come closer please.

Scully closes in.

Jack passes his finger over the bottom lip of Ravinov.

He goes from right to left. Then left to right. Then stops.

SCULLY

What?

JACK

Silence.

Jack goes again, left to right. Left to right. Left to right. Then stops again.

JACK (CONT'D)
There's an engraving.

SCULLY
What do you mean?

JACK
Stop the recording.

Scully follows the order.

JACK (CONT'D)
It says "Hunt me".

Jack swiftly turns to Scully.

JACK (CONT'D)
Okay Scully I need you to listen to
me very carefully.

Scully nods.

JACK (CONT'D)
I'm going to send everyone away
now. Press, police, everybody who
is not strictly necessary.

SCULLY
Am I strictly necessary?

JACK
You are not.

SCULLY
Oh.

JACK
No. But look at me. I have a way
more important job for you. I need
you to drive down and go fetch Dr.
Harry Palmer from his office, tell
him it's for DiAngelo, tell him it
is urgent. Are you listening
Scully?

SCULLY
Yes sir.

JACK
Very well. Then I want you to stop
by the Gazette and pick up a Ms.
Erin Dawes, she is a reporter. Tell
her it's for Jack, tell her it's
urgent.

SCULLY
Why do you need Erin?

JACK
If you have to know- it's because
she is the only one who can tell me
whether I'm the hunter or I'm prey.
(a beat)
Now go go go!

Scully runs away.

JACK (CONT'D)
(loud)
I NEED A PERIMETER ESTABLISHED IN
THE NEXT 5 MINUTES! NO ONE GETS IN
OR OUT WITHOUT MY PERMISSION!

Jack turns to the corner where the press is gathered.

JACK (CONT'D)
Officer! Officer!

He strides over there, where the officer is struggling to
keep the press at bay.

JACK (CONT'D)
Officer.

OFFICER #1
Lieu-Lieutenant.

JACK
(to the press)
I need you ALL to leave right now.
Who will not leave will be arrested
and consequently charged with
obstruction of justice. Am I being
clear?

REPORTER #1
We just want some answers!

JACK
Don't we all now? Please leave, I
will personally release a statement
in a couple of hours when I know
more. Please and thank you.

REPORTER #2
Kids have been dropping like flies
over the past weeks, do you have a
comment on that?

JACK
We are doing everything we can to
stop this Puma massacre.

REPORTER #2
Then you not doing enough.

JACK
(as he leaves)
I know.

Reporters clamor.

OFFICER #1
Come on! Come on! You have heard
the Lieutenant! Free the area at
once!

INT. RAIN FOUNDATION OFFICES - JOHNSON CAMPAIGN OFFICE - DAY

Henriette and George are in the middle of a heated
discussion.

HENRIETTE
This is gettin ridiculous, George.
I'm the goddamn Mayoral candidate.
I *have* to say something.

GEORGE
We have no idea what is going on,
Henri.

HENRIETTE
We don't have- We don't have any
idea what's going on you say. Have
you seen the pictures?

She throws a bunch of pictures of The Batter's dead body on
the picture, along side the killed kids.

George IMMEDIATELY picks them up and puts them in his
pocket.

GEORGE
The public hasn't seen them yet.

HENRIETTE
What if we are the ones that show
them? What if we get ahead of this
shit for once. Attack the current
administration, say they can't
protect them, say they are hiding
this things from them.

GEORGE

Why would you want to terrorize them with this? Both stories are out there already, why give them any reason to be more scared?

HENRIETTE

Because it's The Puma.

GEORGE

We don't know that.

HENRIETTE

It's *always* him.

GEORGE

I see you are softening up on DiAngelo as commissioner.

HENRIETTE

You know, the man might have a point when he says what he says about this Puma.

GEORGE

You know as well as I do The Puma has saved this city countless times.

HENRIETTE

This city never needed saving before he came here.

GEORGE

If there is one thing this is city has always needed, that is someone that would save it.

INT. RAIN PENTHOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY

Josh, running on a treadmill, watches the news on TV.

REPORTER #3

-after last night bloodbath the death toll now stands at eight over the last five nights, not including the criminal known as The Batter.

REPORTER #4

Well, it is to be said that The Batter was responsible himself for a majority of the deaths.

REPORTER #3

So what are you saying? That's how we should deal with criminals? Hanging them in the public square like medieval brutes?

REPORTER #4

That is certainly not what I'm saying, Jessica.

JESSICA

Then I don't know what you are saying. I can't believe after all this years you are still going to sit here and defend that animal.

REPORTER #4

There is no official statement confirming The Puma's involvement in any of last night's events. There were no reports of The Growl. These copycats have been going around for weeks. Who's to say he is really back?

JESSICA

Look at this, Frank.

She PULLS UP one of the pictures we saw on Henriette's desk before.

JESSICA (CONT'D)

No man could do this.

FRANK

Not that we know of.

Josh's watch starts BEEPING. It reads "Incoming call from Ms. Sunshine".

He turns off the TV and picks up.

INTERCUT with Erin in her car.

JOSH

It wasn't me.

ERIN

I know.

JOSH

Have you told Jake?

ERIN
I have.

JOSH
Does he believe you?

ERIN
For now- but it's weird.

JOSH
What?

INT. CAR - SAME TIME

Erin drives through the busy streets of Derry as she speaks with Josh over the speakerphone.

ERIN
It's eerily similar. The wounds,
the cuts, the bites.

JOSH (O.C.)
You don't think it could just be
the work of one- or many- of these
Copycats?

ERIN
Ravinov had "Hunt Me" engraved on
his lower lip.

ON JOSH

We see the GOOSEFLESH on Josh's arm.

JOSH
Where are you now?

ON ERIN

ERIN
I'm going to see Masha.

JOSH (O.C.)
Ravinov?!

ERIN
Do you know any other Mashas?

JOSH (O.C.)
Now why would you do that after
what happened to her brother? You
know how she gets.

ERIN
She gets like that only with you
because you are fucking terrifying.

ON JOSH

Josh stands in front of the spotless windows of the apartment, looking at his feeble reflection.

JOSH
I'm not terrifying.

ERIN (O.C.)
Anyways- Jake also has a couple of questions he needs answered and you know she would never speak to police.

JOSH
He wants questions answered and he is sending you to ask them?

ERIN (O.C.)
What do you mean by *sending me*?

JOSH
It's dangerous.

ERIN (O.C.)
Whatever. I need to go Josh, I'm pulling up to her place.

JOSH
Can you come here right after? I really don't like this "Hunt Me" thing.

JOSH (O.C.) (CONT'D)
No, Josh. I can't come over.

EXT. DERRY OUTSKIRTS - SAME TIME

Erin parks in the driveway of a small, YELLOWISH house.

Erin exits her car, with her phone to her ear.

ERIN
And if you don't like it- then do something about it. God knows we could use your help.

JOSH (O.C.)
Which side?

ERIN
Either of.

Erin hangs up.

She walks up TO THE PORCH, notices accumulated DIRTINESS on the COMPLETELY SHUT CURTAINS.

She goes to KNOCK, but as soon as her KNUCKLES hit the door, they push it forward.

Erin leans forward and she is SUDDENLY PUSHED INSIDE from behind.

As she falls, the door is SHUT behind her.

INT. RAVINOV'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

Light BARELY enters the house.

MASHA RAVINOV, The Batter's TWIN SISTER, TOWERS over ERIN.

Erin SMILES at MASHA, not scared, not intimidated.

ERIN
Nice to see you again, Masha. I see you haven't changed your ways.

MASHA
Don't try to be funny. What the fuck are you doing here?

ERIN
I'm here to ask a couple of questions about your brother.

MASHA
Yeah you said that on the phone. I'm not stupid. Who are you with?

ERIN
Who am- Who am I with?

MASHA
Yeah.

ERIN
You mean- like- credentials? The Derry City Gazette?

Masha steps FORWARD.

MASHA
I told you to not be funny.

ERIN

Masha, I'm not sure I'm following.
What are you talking about?

MASHA

He called me. Like a week ago.
Saying you would come here, today
exactly.

ERIN

What? Who told you that?

MASHA

Sasha.

ERIN

How- what?

MASHA

I don't know what the fuck you were
doing with my brother, but I get
the call, I say- okay, he lost his
mind again- but then he dies. He
fucking dies. And here you are. So
my question is: what the fuck were
you doing with my brother?

ERIN

Masha. You have to believe me I
truly have no idea what you are
talking about.

Masha takes ONE STEP further, right ABOVE Erin.

Masha looks down MENACINGLY.

Erin now gets scared.

Masha REACHES her hand DOWN to Erin.

MASHA

Come on. Get up.

ERIN

You are kidding me.

MASHA

Yeah. I'm fucking with you. I know
you don't know shit, but maybe we
can figure something out together.

Erin takes Masha's hand, stands up.

ERIN

You got me scared for a second there.

MASHA

Yeah. For a second.

INT. KITCHEN - RAVINOV'S HOSUE - MOMENTS LATER

Erin sits at the kitchen table, TWO CUPS, one PINK and one BLUE, are laid in front of her.

Masha STEPS into FRAME, holding a coffee pot.

MASHA

No cream. No sugar. Right?

ERIN

Same as always.

Masha pours the coffee, then sits next to Erin.

MASHA

So- Where to start?

ERIN

First of all: how are you, Masha?

Masha looks around, tightens her lips, slightly nods.

MASHA

What do you want me to say? I have been better. I have been worse. I'm confused, that's for sure.

ERIN

Are you planning a funeral?

MASHA

What for? No one else is going to grieve for him. No one else should.

ERIN

I'm truly sorry, Masha. I thought after last time-

MASHA

I know. It doesn't matter. Let's not- you know- dwell. You are here for a reason and I guess he knew about it, so go ahead, ask what you need to.

ERIN

Do you know what he was up to this days?

MASHA

Murder.

ERIN

For murder's sake?

MASHA

I think it's this copycat business that got him on the edge. He always had a weird obsession for your boyfriend.

ERIN

Masha.

MASHA

What? He is.

ERIN

Was. Whatever. You don't know if he was working with or for someone else?

MASHA

How could I know that? It's not like we had supper together. The call I got literally just was "Erin Dawes is going to want to speak with you in a week, you lat her, okay? You let her". Then he hanged up.

ERIN

This is so weird. Because, the thing is, he had this *engraving* in his lower lip.

MASHA

Engraving?

ERIN

It said "Hunt Me".

MASHA

No way.

ERIN

Yeah.

MASHA
No fucking way.

Masha stands up, BOLTS out of the room.

ERIN
What?

Erin FOLLOWS.

We hear Masha SPRINTING UPSTAIRS.

LIVING ROOM

By the time Erin enters the living room holding her coffee cup, Masha is ALREADY back holding a PRINTED PICTURE.

MASHA
(pointing on the picture)
Look at that.

ERIN
Wait. When is this from?

MASHA
I don't know- like three months ago. It's from his studio. He would send me this pictures every now and then to- you know-
(voice breaks)
Let me know he was alive.

Erin puts an hand on Masha's shoulder.

Masha shakes her head.

MASHA (CONT'D)
But this is good- right?

ERIN
It's very good, Masha. Do you think you could get it?

MASHA
I think I could. Yes.

ERIN
This is crazy.

Erin HOLDS the picture CLOSER to her face.

We finally SEE the picture:

it's a photo of SASHA RAVINOV standing, smiling, in his WHITE SUIT, leaning on a table, a small window ABOVE him. NEXT to him a handwritten note which reads "HUNT ME".

JOSH (OVERLAP)
It doesn't make any sense.

INT. LIVING ROOM - RAIN PENTHOUSE - LATER

Josh STARES out the window, over the RAINY Derry.

Erin stands BEHIND HIM, catching his eyes in the reflection.

JOSH
How could they know?

ERIN
Know what?

JOSH
Everything. That Jack would turn to you, that you would go to Masha, that she would show you the picture, that you would go to The Puma. What if it's not The Puma they want to set on the hunt?

ERIN
Who else, then?

Jake turns to Erin, smiles.

JOSH
How much do you know Jack?

ERIN
Sorry?

JOSH
He has been here, in Derry, for a long time. A lot of bad people he put away. A lot of strange people he put away.

ERIN
Are you implying he is causing this?

JOSH
I'm saying ha has been on TV an awful lot recently, I'm saying there's an election coming up. He is mentioned next to the word "commissioner" every other day.
(MORE)

JOSH (CONT'D)

New fame always comes with new enemies, you know that. And then-you know-

Erin CAN'T believe what she's hearing.

ERIN

What.

JOSH

You are a public couple. Tabloids, TVs, all over the place. Dinner date, ballet, there's the first connection.

ERIN

Are there more?

JOSH

Yes, Erin. Your history. I don't think there has ever been a journalist that is closer to criminals. To Ravinov especially.

ERIN

To Masha.

JOSH

Of course, but you have history with Sasha as well. You have history with almost every major crime in this city.

ERIN

Well I did kind of date The Puma for a while.

He stops for a second, considers saying something, then doesn't.

JOSH

Makes sense that you would be on this. Makes sense that you would go back to Jack, your boyfriend, with the information. Make sense that him, given how much he fucking hates The Puma, would turn into a Puma Poacher in his pursuit of that commissioner title. But guess what? There is no Puma to hunt, not anymore, and he will flush down his career going on this safari.

ERIN
But that's not what happened. I
came to you first.

JOSH
Because they don't know you that
well.

ERIN
What if they do? What if they
somehow know who you are?

Josh inches closer to Erin, LOOKS DOWN at her.

JOSH
Than you need to stay closer than
ever.

Erin LOOKS UP at Josh's eyes.

ERIN
(whisper)
I need you to do this for me.

Erin WRAPS her hands AROUND Josh's neck. He PUTS his hands
around her WAIST.

ERIN (CONT'D)
(even lower)
Make sure Masha is okay. Make sure
Jack is okay. Please.

He NODS.

JOSH
For you. And you only. One last
time.

Josh LEANS in for a KISS, but she TURNS TO HER CHEECK.

He continues to lean FORWARD, DIGGING his head over her
shoulder.

Josh CLOSES his arms behind Erin's back.

Erin PASSES her hands through his air.

ERIN
Thank you.

INT. FAMILY QUARTERS - REIN PENTHOUSE - DAY

Josh TIGHTENS his necktie, CLOSES his CUFFLINKS with an "R" engraved, then walks to the elevator.

The elevator opens up on GEORGE, he looks at Josh's WRISTS.

GEORGE
Are we going to work?

JOSH
I think we are George.

Josh STEPS into the elevator.

George goes to press the downstairs button, Josh STOPS him.

JOSH (CONT'D)
Nope.

Josh turns to the MIRROR behind them.

EXCITEMENT SPARKS in George's eyes, but quickly turns into APPREHENSION.

George turns to the mirror.

They look at each other in their reflections.

JOSH (CONT'D)
Want to do the honors?

GEORGE
Why now?

JOSH
Erin came by last night-

George shakes in head, DISAPPOINTED, cutting Josh off.

George PRESS his THUMB right in the middle of the mirror.

ORANGE LIGHTS descend upon the cubicle.

INTERCOM
Harrison, George Stuart. Exclusive
passkey required.

GEORGE
Eternal Recurrence.

INTERCOM
Access: Granted.

Sounds of machines igniting CONQUER the elevator.

GEORGE
You really need to oil this thing.

JOSH
Yeah. It's been a while.

The elevator WALLS start ROTATING to their right, slowly, loudly, LABORIOUSLY.

As their REFLECTIONS LEAVE the mirror.

JOSH (CONT'D)
Do you still believe in that?

GEORGE
The eternal recurrence?

JOSH
Yeah.

They now face one of the elevator walls, we see them from behind their shoulders.

GEORGE
I choose not to.

JOSH
Can you even chose what you believe into?

The walls rotate one more time, bringing the elevator doors IN FRONT OF THEM.

GEORGE
We can always choose.

The elevator doors OPEN on...

A MAJESTIC STAIRCASE leading to a CIRCULAR PLATFORM with computers on its sides. At the end of the platform facing them, a STATUE not yet visible.

They STEP inside and, as they do, a WHITE light DESCENDS, almost MYSTICALLY, on the STATUE revealing A CRYSTAL BUST, upon which lays THE MASK OF THE PUMA.

The elevator door CLOSES in front of us.

The walls RAPIDLY rotate back to their original formation, leaving us in front of the mirror.

INT. PUMA'S DEN - CONTINUOUS

Lights constellating the staircase DIMLY highlight the STEEP ROCKS surrounding it.

GEORGE
Those things used to be brighter
didn't they?

George heads for the stairs, not realizing Josh has FROZEN.

GEORGE (CONT'D)
(turning to his left)
Didn't they?

He looks back, where he sees Josh holding himself to the METAL WALL, breathing raggedly with his EYES wide and empty.

GEORGE (CONT'D)
Hey! Kid! Look at me.

Josh turns to him.

GEORGE (CONT'D)
You don't have to do this. You
don't have to do anything.

Josh closes his eyes, takes a DEEP BREATH, then- all in the SAME BREATH- takes his hand AWAY from the wall and STEADIES himself.

He opens his eyes back, looks right at George, then at the Mask. He hears a GROWL.

JOSH
But I can do it. Me and no one
else.

He takes STRIDE upon the stairs, passing George.

JOSH (CONT'D)
I'll fix the lights.
(as he keeps going)
Now come on. There's a lot to do.

CENTRAL PLATFORM

Josh takes a QUICK look at The Puma mask, then takes center stage on the platform.

George takes a sit in front of one of the computer.

JOSH (CONT'D)
 Let's start from this "Puma
 Copycats". What do we know about
 them?

George presses some buttons on the large keyboard. VIDEOS
 AND IMAGES of young people cosplaying as The Puma appear on
 the two screens.

GEORGE
 Not much. They first start
 appearing on social media about
 three months ago, apparently as an
 organic response to the
 disappearance of The Puma.

Some videos show The Copycats HELPING people, othesr show
 them LOOTING and TERRORIZING.

JOSH
 This is- strange.
 What is their goal? Are we sure
 they are not just a bunch of kids
 putting on a mask to do what they
 are too scared to do in the open?

GEORGE
 That's probably part of it.

ERIN
 Erin told me Jack believes there is
 someone behind them. Can we trace
 the first of these videos?

GEORGE
 We can and we can't. This is as far
 back as we can go, but there's no
 way of knowing if something came
 before.

A single video takes stage on BOTH screens.

A PLASTIC PUMA mask sits on a table, a distorted voice
 speaks over it.

COPYCAT
 The Puma DIDN'T DIE. He ABANDONED
 us. He saw the chance to DIP and
 DIPPED. You know who FLINCHES and
 RUNS AWAY? A scared little stray
 cat. He will hiss at your face
 before BOLTING in the opposite
 direction. That is what his growl
 was. A SCARED LITTLE HISS.
 (MORE)

COPYCAT (CONT'D)

Because you know who didn't dip? We didn't. The people of Derry. We were left here. Crime rates skyrocketing, more murders than before The Puma appeared. And you know why? Because they think he is DEAD. They think this is their city. But IT'S NOT. IT'S ours. WE CAN TAKE IT BACK. BECAUSE WE ARE NOT SCARED. WE WON'T HISS AND RUN AWAY. WE WILL GROWL AND MOWL. WE ARE THE PEOPLE OF DERRY. WE ARE THE PUMA.

Static.

JOSH

Is it love or is it hate?

GEORGE

It's a fine line. You know that, Josh.

JOSH

Can you trace that? Somehow?

GEORGE

I can try.

JOSH

Good. Try. Gotta give it to Jack, he is smart, that doesn't feel organic at all. Seems more like organized chaos. What's Commissioner Whitaker stance on this?

GEORGE

Stance is an overstatement. The man is on his way out. DiAngelo is leading on this.

JOSH

He seems to think it's leading back to The Puma. Like I'm the one that he should hunt.

GEORGE

What do you mean?

JOSH

Wait- Is that not public? Pull up Erin's file, last two issues.

George types Erin Dawes. No response.

JOSH (CONT'D)
You know what's she's under.

George, once again, shakes his head, then types "MS. SUNSHINE".

One image appears on each screen: the inscription on The Batter's lip and the note on The Batter's desk.

GEORGE
What the hell?

JOSH
Yeah.

GEORGE
And he thinks this is The Puma's doing?

JOSH
Erin told him it isn't.

GEORGE
But the inscription matches the note at the supply system. Doesn't it?

JOSH
Yeah.

GEORGE
That fucking documentary.

JOSH
It's okay.

GEORGE
I told her it was daft.

JOSH
How could she have known?

GEORGE
She should have.

JOSH
Not the point here.

GEORGE
Whoever is behind this knows her, Josh. Knows her well.

JOSH

I don't want to talk about this now, George. What I want to talk about is: tomorrow Masha is going to Sasha's house to take that note, so they can triangulate it with the other two.

GEORGE

It's going to match, again.

JOSH

I know, but I didn't do it and I'm guessing whoever did will also be there.

GEORGE

You are kidding. You *have* to be at the debate. All the support you gave Henriette will mean *nothing* if you are not there.

JOSH

I'm the son of Alexander Rein.

GEORGE

And? The sins of the father are not the sins of the son. We don't do that.

JOSH

George. I have to make sure they are alright.

GEORGE

They?

JOSH

Masha and Jack. He is going to follow her.

GEORGE

This evidently a deliberate deception.

JOSH

As I said, Jack is smart, but he's blinded. He wants that commissioner title and getting The Puma- that's a rocket ship to that- and God knows what more.

GEORGE

I meant a deception for you. If someone is out there, weaving this intricate web, it is not to catch a Lieutenant. It is big game hunting.

JOSH

I can take care of myself.

Josh turns to THE MASK, puts an hand over it.

George turns to him, VISIBLY GULPS.

EXT. TOWN HALL - NIGHT

COMMISSIONER GAVIN WITHAKER (70's) in FULL UNIFORM is giving an interview to the SIGNIFICANT CROWD of reporters gathered in front of him on the stairs of Town Hall.

WITHAKER

I understand the public concern given the events of the past few days, but the city has seen worse and we are ready for any eventuality. We have implemented measures *beyond* our traditional maximum security measures and I can ensure tonight's debate will be nothing but a celebration of democracy and the respectful exchange of opinions that define our beautiful city.

QUESTIONS FLY at the commissioner.

WITHAKER (CONT'D)

I will now take *one* question as I'm needed elsewhere.

Withaker scrutinizes the crowd, then, with an almost imperceptible grin, points at someone in the back of the crowd.

"REPORTER"

What are the measures "*beyond ordinary maximum security*" you have implemented?

WITHAKER

Oh. I'm glad you asked.

As he finishes the sentence, STEEL NETS DROP FROM THE TOP OF TOWN HALL covering the entirety of its front.

OFFICERS quickly run behind the commissioner to TIE the nets to the top of the GRANITE STAIRS.

WITHAKER (CONT'D)

Ladies and gentlemen. 2222 pounds of fresh steel, holes so tight not even MP7 bullets could sneak behind, I present to you: The Puma Cather. If that monster even thinks of-

The interview transitions into TV footage as move too...

INT. JACK'S OFFICE - SAME TIME

Jack, Erin and Scully are gathered around the table while the footage plays on TV.

WITHAKER (O.C.)

-showing his muzzle around here, I can assure you- he got another thing coming.

SCULLY

As if that could ever stop him.

JACK

It doesn't matter. He is not going to be there.

ERIN

Because he is going to be at Ravinov's?

JACK

Babe. I trust you. You know better than anyone else how he operates. If you say he has nothing to do with all this, then he doesn't.

They kiss.

ERIN

I still don't think you should go alone.

JACK

Scully will be at the Breezeway, ready to call for reinforcements if needed- but hey

(turns to Erin)

You don't have to worry. Whoever is behind this is smart.

(MORE)

JACK (CONT'D)
they are subtle, sneaky,
calculating, they know I'll be
there.

ERIN
I know they will. That's why I'm
worried.

Jack kisses her again. She tries to smile, but fails.

JACK
They are just going to leave one
more clue. I wouldn't go in alone
if there were any real risk.

WITHAKER (O.C.)
Everyone will get home safe
tonight, I can promise you that.

JACK
See? You even got the commissioner
promise.

ERIN
You are an idiot.

Erin looks at her watch.

ERIN (CONT'D)
Okay. Gotta get down to Town Hall,
however I'm going to get inside.

JACK
Have fun, baby.

ERIN
Sure. You be safe.

She points to Scully.

ERIN (CONT'D)
Anything. And you call me right
away, understood?

SCULLY
Yes, ma'am.

ERIN
Very good.

Erin kisses Jack, then leaves.

Jack watches her leave with a smile on his face, which DROPS as soon as her heels can no longer be heard.

JACK
You got it?

SCULLY
Yessir.

Scully takes a BRIEFCASE from UNDER the table. She STRUGGLES to pick it up and ends up SLAMMING it on the table.

She OPENS it in front of Jack.

POV: THE BRIEFCASE.

From underneath we see a somewhat MALICIOUS grin appearing on JACK's face.

JACK
Spectacular.

EXT. TOWN HALL - LATER

Erin ADVANCES towards the POLICE LINE in front of Town Hall walking through a SEA of people.

Some of them, even some CHILDREN, wear Puma PLASTIC MASKS.

She reaches the start of the POLICE CORRIDOR leading to the entrance.

She delves into her jacket to get her PRESS ACCREDITATION LANYARD, when...

OFFICER #3
Ms. Dawes, please.

The officer shifts to let Erin through.

ERIN
Thank you, Hannah.

Erin walks through the police corridor, towards the GIANT METAL NET covering Town Hall's facade.

Photographers HUSTLE to capture pics of Erin walking this ABSURD RED CARPET.

Some scream her name, some scream "Ms. Dawes", some eves "Mrs. DiAngelo", but then, suddenly, someone behind her screams...

VOICE
MS. SUNSHINE!

Erin FREEZES just before she can step on the FIRST stair.

She turns to the crowd, FATHOMING every inch of it.

She SQUINTS, TILTS her head. Maybe she has seen someone, maybe she hasn't.

She SHAKES her head, CHEEKILY SMILES and POSES, before quickly hopping to the NET.

OFFICER #4
Name and accreditation.

ERIN
You know me, Stuart.

STUART
No exceptions. Maximum security.

ERIN
(knocking on the net)
And beyond.
(a beat)
Erin Lily Dawes. Derry Gazzette.

Stuart turns to a colleague on the right, the colleague nods.

Stuart takes a key in his pocket, puts in the net and TWISTS, opening a DOOR in the net.

Erin DRAMATICALLY enters the net, which is IMMEDIATELY shut off behind her.

ERIN (CONT'D)
You think this would keep him out?

OFFICER #5
Wouldn't you know?

ERIN
I would. I do. And it won't.

STUART
Won't?

ERIN
Wouldn't. Sorry

Erin GROWLS softly, then enters the building.

INT. TOWN HALL - CONTINUOUS

Inside the Town Hall men in TAILORED SUITS and women in elegant LUXURY DRESSES walk through metal detectors surrounded by ARMED guards.

Erin takes her place in the line.

The GUEST in front of her turns back.

GUEST
Erin Dawes, right?

ERIN
That is right. Yes.

GUEST
I really thought he was dead.

ERIN
Maybe he is.

GUEST
They wouldn't do all this if they weren't sure. Come on.

ERIN
You'd be surprised.

As she finishes the sentence, she SPOTS someone across the room, she EXITS her queue and BOLTS away.

Erin DRIBBLES through the penguin herd to reach a DOCTOR DALE PALMER (60's) who is just about to go through the METAL SCAN.

She takes place behind him. People in the line protest.

ERIN (CONT'D)
I'm press, calm down people.

DR. PALMER
(as he goes through)
Ms. Dawes.

ERIN
Doctor Palmer.

Erin walks through the detector and joins Dr. Palmer.

They head for the CONFERENCE ROOM at the end of the entrance hall.

DR. PALMER
I don't suppose your rush was due a
desire of walking your old friend.

ERIN
Then you can also suppose the
reason for my rush.

They enter the CONFERENCE HALL.

INT. CONFERENCE HALL - CONTINUOUS

As they STEP INSIDE, they leave the military base atmosphere
behind.

All sort of DRAPING AND TINSELS decorate the SPACIOUS
conference hall.

DR. PALMER
I can.

ERIN
So?

GEORGE appears next to Erin.

GEORGE
Where the hell have you been?

ERIN
A second, George.

DR. PALMER
Mr. Harrison.

GEORGE
Dr. Palmer.

ERIN
Dale.

DR. PALMER
They match. Yes. You know they do.

SILENCE briefly falls on the trio.

Dr. Palmer politely smiles.

DR. PALMER (CONT'D)
If you'll excuse me now.

GEORGE
Of course.

ERIN
Have a good evening, Dale.

DR. PALMER
Of course.

Dr. Palmer leaves.

GEORGE
The wounds on Ravinov?

ERIN
Yeah.

GEORGE
Is it-

ERIN
Tightest of locks. At least ahead
of the debate.

GEORGE
Henriette leaked the pictures.

ERIN
That's a good strategy.

George shakes his head.

ERIN (CONT'D)
Is Josh-

GEORGE
Don't. Don't do that to me. You owe
me at least that much respect.

She brings her eyes to the ground.

ERIN
Where have you seated me?

George points at an empty chair RIGHT NEXT to the
questioning panel.

ERIN (CONT'D)
Thank you.

GEORGE
Yeah.

Erin starts heading for her seat, then stops.

ERIN
By the way, who's moderating?

GEORGE

I don't know. A certain Audrey Horne. They are debuting her tonight.

Erin looks back, puzzled.

INT. BREEZWAY MOTEL ROOM - SAME TIME

Scully sits on the bed of the SQUALID motel room. On TV, on mute, PANELISTS discuss ahead of the big debate.

Next to her her WALKIE-TALKIE emits STATIC noises.

She lets herself go on the bed, when...

JACK (WALKIE)

Scully do you read me?

SCULLY

Loud and clear. Are you in position?

INT. JACK'S CAR - SAME TIME

Jack sits behind the wheel of his car walkie-talkie in hand. Binoculars resting on the DASHBOARD, the BRIEFCASE from earlier OPEN AND EMPTY on the PASSENGER SIT

JACK

Yes. Street is completely empty. Waiting for target. Standing by.

As ends the phrase, we MOVE to...

EXT. STREET - SAME TIME

From an HIGH-POINT we get a view of this DECREPIT CUL-DE-SAC.

While all houses have signs of DECADENCE, there is no doubt regarding which one is The Batter's former home.

On the house VERY END of the street, weeds have completely TAKEN OVER the lawn, GRAFFITI can be seen on the walls.

One car is parked at the entrance of the street, JACK'S.

Another car drives out, someone exits their home to walk their dog.

A window LIGHTS UP a few houses ahead of Jack.

JACK (V.O.)
It's quiet.

We PUSH IN on that window, ENTERING it.

INT. ABANDONED HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

The LIVING ROOM is empty for everything but a hole-ridden couch.

JOSH STEPS into frame, wearing a HOODIE AND CAP.

He PUSHES the couch IN FRONT OF the window, oriented to Ravinov's house, then SITS on it.

JACK (V.O.)
It's too quiet.

HEADLIGHTS FLASH on Josh's face.

He TRACKS the car with his eyes, and so do we to go...

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

Masha's car drives all the way down the street. Parks right in front of Sasha's house.

INT. CAR - CONTINUOUS

Masha KILLS the engine. She takes the keys out of the switch, DROPS it.

MASHA
Fuck.

She bends to get the key, but it's dark. Fumbles a little.

MASHA (CONT'D)
Chyort!
(DAMN IT!)

A THUMP.

She LOCKS. Robotically sits back up.

Hands on her thighs, she SLOWLY rotates her head, left to right.

A THUMP. AGAIN. FROM THE BACK OF THE CAR.

She CLUTCHES her fists.

Watchfully, she continues her head rotation to the back, where she finds... NOTHING.

She exhales.

THUMP. UNDER THE CAR.

She EXPLODES out of the car.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

Masha SLAMS the door behind her, takes a couple of steps back from the car.

INT. CAR - SAME TIME

Jack observes through his binoculars. Grabs his walkie.

JACK
(whispered)
Scully come in. Something's going
on.

INT. ABANDONED HOUSE - SAME TIME

Josh, standing up, peeps at Masha through the little opening between the curtains.

JOSH POV: we see Masha slowly approaching the car. She takes a KNEE in front of the car, then looks under it.

JOSH (O.C.)
What are you doing, Masha?

JOSH POV: Masha quickly takes her head away from under the car. Kneels, shakes her head and stands up. She proceeds towards the entrance of the house.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

BACK on Masha next to her car, she has a smile on her face, still shaking her head she heads for the entrance of the house.

We STAY next to her car as she JAMS the door open.

A CAT with a MOUSE in his mouth SKEDADDLES away from beneath her car.

INT. BREEZWAY MOTEL ROOM - SAME TIME

Scully holds the walkie.

SCULLY
Lieutenant talk to me.

JACK
Everything okay, she went in.
Moving closer.

SCULLY
Copy.

On TV, THE PRESENTER has taken center stage between the two debate podiums.

Scully UNMUTES.

PRESENTER
(on TV)
Ladies and Gentlemen welcome to the final debate for this year's Derry City mayoral election. I know that both are in-house and at-home audiences can't wait for their concerns to be addressed, but allow me to first introduce our Moderator, Mrs. Audrey Horne, that will quickly recap-

Scully MUTES the TV once again.

INT. CONFERENCE HALL - BACKSTAGE - MOMENTS LATER

Behind the curtain, George and Henriette go through the last minutes adjustments.

HENRIETTE
-but Josh is not here. Right?

GEORGE
It's my understanding that he is not.

HENRIETTE
Your understanding?

GEORGE
Not the easiest person to track down, that man.

Henriette brings her hands together, breathes into them.

George takes her hands into his.

She looks up at him.

GEORGE (CONT'D)
You got this. I believe in you.

HENRIETTE
Thank you, George.

A PRODUCER walks up to them.

PRODUCER
On in 5...4...

HENRIETTE
What's our official position on The
Puma?

PRODUCER
3...2

GEORGE
It's whatever your position is.

PRODUCER
1...

PRESENTER (O.C.)
Ladies and Gentlemen, give it up
for Henriette Johnson.

HENRIETTE
Let's fucking go.

She turns around, heads for the stage.

George quietly observes her taking in the applause, a HELD
BACK smile appearing on his face.

CONFERENCE HALL STAGE - MOMENTS LATER

MAYOR FRANKLIN FIELDS (50's) stands behind the right podium,
Henriette on the left.

AUDREY
Mayor Fields. You are- as you so
often like to point out- a true,
native Derrian. You were born here.
You were raised here. You studied
here all the way through law school
and had very little working
experience outside of city limits.

FIELDS
That's right.

AUDREY

Now, you have of course been Mayor of Derry for the past eight years and of course the city has seen its fair share of change throughout your legislature. My question therefore is: how close is the current Derry City to the one I assume you imagined growing up here?

FIELDS

That's a really good question, Ms. Horne. Thank you very much. Well-to be completely honest with you, when I was boy, growing up down by the port on Nettle Street, I imagined a future where boats could fly across the ocean and humanoid robots took care of unloading the docks.

Audience laughs. Fields smiles COMPLACENT.

FIELDS (CONT'D)

Forgive me for the joke Ms. Johnson and Mrs. Horne.

AUDREY

The time is running, Mayor Fields.

FIELDS

Of course. What I really envisioned, when I was young and bright-eyed, was a Derry City where people didn't have to load and unload the docks for fifteen hours a rent to make ends meet. A Derry City where you wouldn't have to choose whether you get an education or you get to eat. A Derry City where every man, woman or child, regardless of their provenience or destination could walk around at any time of day or night without having to worry about who's going to jump out the next corner. Did I achieve all of that? No. Of course not. But I do believe we are on the right track. I do believe if we stay the course we can bring Derry where it should have always been.

(MORE)

FIELDS (CONT'D)

Eight years ago violent crime was at an all time high, unemployment at an all time low. We couldn't put people in homes, because we couldn't put money in their pockets. We needed structural reforms. And that is exactly what we did. Violent crime has gone down every single year of our administration. The homelessness crisis is virtually resolved. The city is on its course to the future I always envisioned.

A BEEPER goes off on Ms. Horne.

AUDREY

Oh! Perfect timing Mr. Mayor.

FIELDS

Not my first time Ms. Horne.

Audrey turns to Henriette.

AUDREY

Ms. Johnson. Although you are not from Derry originally, you have been living in the city for over twenty years now, having moved here to start your career as a lawyer. Do you have any comments on Mayor Field's remark that the city is on the right path? And a follow-up. Do you think Derry has changed over the course of your stay here? If so, has it changed for the better or for the worse in your opinion?

HENRIETTE

Thank you, Ms. Horne. Me and you both are from the state of Washington and I'm guessing I moved here when you were just a little girl. What many young people in Derry probably don't know is that the city I moved to was close to what Mayor Fields mentioned to be envisioning. A city that prospers, that *exudes prepositive energy*, where everything seems possible as there is no reason that wouldn't be the case.

(MORE)

HENRIETTE (CONT'D)

As we all know, that is not what Derry came to be in the end. The city soon, slowly and steadily took a curse for the worse.

(a beat)

I am a big believer in cycles, ladies and gentlemen. History doesn't run in a straight line, it is recursive upon itself. I saw all the signs of Derry's decadence as they were happening, and I'm seeing them again. I see the people struggling. I see the violence crawling angsty in the underbelly of this beautiful city. That is why I stepped up. That is why I stepped up and decided to take this challenge head on. The mayor mentioned the reduction in crime over the course of his mandate, yet he failed to acknowledge the spike in violent deaths we have seen over the course of the past year. I find it very ironic that the city has just been described as safe and secure when this debate is being held in a Town Hall sealed into a cage.

FIELDS

That has nothing to do with-

AUDREY

Mr. Mayor, I kindly ask you to not interrupt and I'm not asking again. Please- Ms. Johnson.

HENRIETTE

People are afraid. All the way from Nettle to Main. The city is facing an obscure void, and while its administration is choosing to turn its back to it, I know that is not what the people of Derry want, nor need. They live in the real world. They need capable leadership-

BEEP. BEEP. BEEP.

AUDREY

That will be all the time for this section of the debate, Ms. Johnson.

The audience quietly MURMURS.

Henriette forces a polite smile, then turns to GEORGE.

BEHIND THE CURTAIN

George nods in approval.

STAGE

Henriette nods back.

MODERATOR TABLE

AUDREY

We are going to take a five minutes
break now. We'll be back with the
debate shortly.

As the crowd SCATTERS behind Audrey, Erin JUMPS next to the
moderator.

ERIN

Hi.

Audrey is STARTLED, yet immediately composes herself back to
genuine politeness.

AUDREY

Hi.

ERIN

I'm-

AUDREY

Erin Dawes. I'm aware.

ERIN

Oh. I don't think we had the
pleasure Ms.-

AUDREY

Horne. Audrey Horne. And no. We
haven't. Backroom staff. We
wouldn't really had the chance.

ERIN

I'm sure we would have crossed path
at some points, it's not that big
of a city.

AUDREY

I have seen smaller, *and weirder*,
Ms. Dawes.

Audrey stands up.

AUDREY (CONT'D)
If you'll excuse me, it is *my* big
night after all.

ERIN
No. Yeah. Of course.

Erin extends her hand.

ERIN (CONT'D)
It was pleasure to meet you,
Audrey.

AUDREY
Ms. Horne.

Audrey extends her hand back.

AUDREY (CONT'D)
Likewise, Ms. Dawes.

Audrey BARELY touches Erin's hand.

Erin, not feeling any pressure, looks down at their hands.

ERIN
I really like your ring.

Audrey TINKLES with joy at the compliment.

AUDREY
Yes. It's very nice.

Audrey RETRACTS her hand with a FELINE gesture.

AUDREY (CONT'D)
See you around.

ERIN
Of course.

Audrey leaves, disappearing into the crowd.

INT. CAR - SAME TIME

Jack holds his Walkie.

JACK
Scully- moving closer.

Jack shuts off his headlights and slowly proceeds towards
The Batter's house.

EXT. STREET - CONTINUOUS

We see Jack's car passing the house where Josh is observing.

As Jack's strides past it, the light in the house goes off.

A few moments later, Josh exits the house with his cap and hood on.

EXT. SASHA'S HOUSE - ENTRANCE - CONTINUOUS

Masha walks up the porch, to the door.

Naturally, she LOWERS HERSELF to the plant of PURPLE HYACINTH on her left.

She BRUSHES the soil aside to find the BRONZE KEY to the house.

Masha SMILES as she picks it up and turns to the door.

She enters the key in the lock.

MASHA
(as she turns the key)
Talk to me, Sasha.

Masha enters the house.

As she closes the door behind herself, Jack's car pulls on the opposite side of the street.

INT. SASHA'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

DARK. The only light comes in from the little window above the entrance door. Barely enough to see Masha herself.

MASHA
Hello?

Masha ADVANCES.

The floor CREEKS with every step.

Masha taps with her hand on the wall as she proceeds.

MASHA (CONT'D)
Where the fuck is it?

She stumbles on something, almost falls, in doing so she inadvertently hits the switch.

MASHA (CONT'D)
AHHH!

LIGHTS UP.

She realizes she tripped on a pair of BLOODY WHITE PANTS.

She JUMPS back, disgusted AND ashamed.

SLOWLY, she brings her eyes up, expecting to find the worse, but nothing.

There's nothing out of the ordinary other than the pants.

Not on the floor ahead, not on the staircase to the upper floor.

MASHA (CONT'D)

Okay.

She EXAGGERATEDLY surpasses the pants, then stops before the passage to the living room.

She PROBES with her right hand around the corner.

Nothing.

Again, with the left hand reaches around the corner.

Lights in the living room go on.

Masha brings her eyes to her feet.

MASHA (CONT'D)

And there it is.

EXT. STREET - SAME TIME

Josh hidden behind a wall, observes the developing on the situation.

The dark, thick curtains are energetically PULLED APART.

Masha appears in the window.

SPLATTERS of blood on the walls and a dead person on the couch can be seen behind her.

Masha looks around, then closes again the drapes.

JOSH

Jesus Christ.

INT. CAR - SAME TIME

Akin to Josh, Jack observes the display of violence in full display for an even better angle.

We don't see what he sees, we see him FLINCHING, then grabbing the walkie.

JACK

Scully. There are at least three dead bodies in the house. God knows how long they have been there, how long have their families been waiting for us to find them.

INT. BREEZWAY MOTEL ROOM - SAME TIME

Scully is now lying on the bed, staring at the ceiling as she waits for the debate to resume.

SCULLY

Do you need me to call reinforcements?

JACK

Not yet.

SCULLY

Copy that.

INT. SASHA'S HOUSE - MOMENTS LATER

Masha walks over to the kitchen.

There are dishes in the sink.

A half eaten pizza on the table. She trudges to the fridge.

Next to a shopping list, there's a faded picture of them as children.

She's dressed as a fairy, he is in a baseball outfit, leaning on a child-sized bat.

She takes the picture from the fridge, takes a second to observe it.

MALE VOICE

(behind her)

He told me to never touch it.

Masha DROPS the picture, PETRIFIED.

MALE VOICE (CONT'D)

I assume you are Masha, he told me you would come here.

Masha GULPS.

MALE VOICE (CONT'D)
I'm not going to hurt you. You can
trust me. He trusted me.

MASHA
(Without turning)
Who are you?

MALE VOICE
I'm just Lewis.

Masha, COUNTING EACH STEP, turns to LEWIS, to find in front
of her, just a SCARED, SCRAWNY young man.

LEWIS
Hi.

MASHA
Who are you?

LEWIS
I told you, I'm just Lewis.

Masha STRIDES UP to him, pushes Lewis into a wall.

MASHA
What are you doing here? Did you
follow me? Who are you with?

LEWIS
I- I live here. I have a mattress I
the spare room upstairs.

MASHA
What?

LEWIS
He told me I could stay here as
much as I needed to.

Masha takes her hands of Lewis' clothes.

MASHA
How long have you been living here?

LEWIS
I don't know. Six months? It was
before he went crazy. I- I didn't
know who he was when I met him.

MASHA
You were Sasha's roommate?

LEWIS

Kind of. Yes. He seemed nice. He took me in. I had no idea. God. I truly had no idea.

Lewis breaks down. Masha puts a hand on his shoulder.

MASHA

Why didn't you leave?

LEWIS

To go where? I have nobody. Nobody. What if he thought I had gone to the police? I would have ended up like them. I had no choice. I truly had no choice.

Lewis leans into Masha, keeps crying.

LEWIS (CONT'D)

The screams. They all screamed so loud. They begged him to stop, but there was no stopping him. He wanted to know where he was. That's all he cared about. But they didn't know. They never knew.

Lewis collapses to the floor.

Masha cruches down to him.

MASHA

Where *who* was?

Lewis looks up at her.

LEWIS

The Puma.

INT. CONFERENCE HALL STAGE - SAME TIME

Henriette is on the microphone.

HENRIETTE

-of course I cannot speak for the foundation, but I can speak for myself when I say that my decision is not to affiliate with the Rein's name, but rather with the foundation's history and mission.

(MORE)

HENRIETTE (CONT'D)

It would be, in my opinion, quite short-sighted to forever tie the centuries-old history of a founding family of Derry to the deplorable act of one disgruntled individual.

FIELDS

Is that what you think of Dr. Rein? That he was a disgruntled individual that operated alone? Without a solid conspiracy of silence that clearly included both his family and historic collaborators, such as your own campaign advisor George Harrison? I think that is preposterous Ms. Johnson and quite frankly and insult to the intelligence of the people of Derry. Dr. Rain was an evil man who made fools of everybody, one which when discovered, planned to take out every single living person in the city with him. You are standing by his name. You are standing by him.

HENRIETTE

Mayor Fields those are some hasty accusation you are throwing around, as a lawyer I hope you have solid proof to support your claims, and if so, I suggest you turn them into DA office first in the morning. But since I know that is not the case, I'd rather ask how the all Dr. Rain was allowed to happen under your administration, and more importantly how- in a city that you claim to be running as smoothly as ever- the only resolution was brought through a bloodbath at the hands of the vigilante known as The Puma.

The crowd GASPS.

MODERATOR TABLE

Next to the table Erin SHUTS her eyes, camera flashes find her immediately.

AUDREY

Mayor Fields? A rebuttal?

FIELDS

Of course. We cannot ignore The Puma. It is a reality of our great city. The Puma has been around since before I was mayor, and I'd like to think he'll be around when I step down. The Puma has helped us fight the fights us mere mortals could not handle. I profoundly disagree with the villainization that many- including Ms. Johnson through her candidate for commissioner Lt. DiAngel- have been steadily conducting over the past few months. Do I agree with his methods? No, I don't condone senseless violence. Do I cherish his presence and wish he had finally return to Derry? Wholeheartedly.

AUDREY

Interesting. Ms. Johnson, I see you shaking your head.

HENRIETTE

Yes, Ms. Horne. I shake my head when I hear the mayor of a city, the man who is supposed to lead it, cherish and plead for the return of a *beast*. A monster whose violence has not has been inspiring many others. The Puma is the curse this city would choose to impose upon itself where Mayor Field to be re-elected. We need justice. We don't need blood. We need people. We don't need *animals*.

THE GROWL

Time stands still.

We RAPIDLY see:

- Erin looking at the stage.
- George, appearing from behind the curtain, looking at her.
- Henriette and Fields shaking in fear.
- Audrey, her lips almost imperceptibly forming a conniving smile.

Then, at

BREEZWAY MOTEL ROOM

- Scully, her mouth opened, reaching for the walkie.

CONFERENCE HALL

Back on Erin, she looks around without moving, then...

ALL HELL BREAKS LOOSE.

GUESTS JUMP ON THEIR FEET, SCREAMING IN TERROR, HURRYING TO THE EXIT DOOR.

SECURITY, GUNS DROWN, JUMPS ON STAGE TO SECURE THE CANDIDATES.

Security escorts the candidates behind the curtain.

A police officer approaches Erin.

OFFICER #3

You go with them, Ms. Dawes.

ERIN

But-

OFFICER #3

No buts. You go with them.

The officer pushes Erin up the stairs and behind the curtain, as Erin watches the panicked people flood towards the exit doors.

BREEZWAY MOTEL ROOM

The livestream on TV cuts off.

Scully is still flabbergasted, but she shakes her head and jumps on her feet.

She takes the walkie.

SCULLY

(as she leaves the room)

JACK! HE IS BACK! HE IS AT THE
DEBATE! HE GROWLED! HE FUCKING
GROWLED!

BREEZWAY MOTEL CORRIDOR

Scully exits her room in a rush, slams the door behind her.

She turns a corner.

We are on her face.

She is walking.

She is determined.

A straight face.

Her lips move.

Quiver.

She contains it, it turns into a smile.

She takes a left.

And she STOPS.

Face goes emotionless.

She turns to her left.

CAMERA follows her sight.

A door is AJAR.

There is light inside.

Scully walks to and through the door.

As she closes it we see the room number: 0224

ROOM 0224

Scully closes the door behind her.

The room is completely empty, there isn't even a bed.

The lights FLICKER.

A grey leather couch appears.

Scully finds herself to be seated in an armchair.

There is a candle running close to its flame on the bedside table next to her.

Scully looks at the couch.

A dense fog appears and quickly takes the shape of a man and a woman.

He wears a black suit, she is in a long blue dress, but their heads are nothing but a dense mist..

The man turns to the woman and says something, but it's muffled.

The woman turns to Scully.

HEADLESS WOMAN
It could be the end.

SCULLY
End of what?

The man turns to Scully.

He tilts his head.

Muffles sounds come out of his cloud.

HEADLESS WOMAN
It is not a cycle, it is not a
circle.

The man stands up and walks to Scully.

He squats in front of her.

His cloud inches from Scully.

He emits muffled sounds.

HEADLESS WOMAN (CONT'D)
It is the fire we walk with. And
you are burning.

Flames surround them.

The man kneels, sounds like he is crying behind the fog.

The woman points her mist at Scully, Scully looks back at her mist.

HEADLESS WOMAN (CONT'D)
You'll be back.

Scully turns to the fire, then it all goes away, in a GLIMPSE.

The room looks like any other room.

We hear some keys.

A couple enters.

They kiss as they fall on the bed.

GUY #1
Are you ready for this Puma?

GIRL #1
Always.

They kiss again, then...

As they kiss...

We hear THE GROWL.

INT. SASHA'S HOUSE - SAME TIME

Lewis shivers and cries, crawled up in a corner. Masha peeps out the window.

She sees Jack's car BOLT away from the house, then, a few moments later, a man in a hat (JOSH) walk out from a house and head in the same direction.

MASHA
Why are they leaving?

LEWIS
(with his head between
the knees)
Who is?

MASHA
The police.

Lewis springs on his feet.

LEWIS
The police? What do you mean you
are with the police?

MASHA
I'm not with the police, but they
were following me. I am not dumb.

LEWIS
They left though.

MASHA
They did. Which doesn't make sense.
Something bigger is happening here.
You need to give me the all story,
my dear Lewis.

Lewis GULPS.

INT. CONFERENCE HALL - SAME TIME

The respectable guests HUDDLE the exit like terrified cattle during a thunderstorm.

Police tries to contain them, but there's only so much they can do as the mess spills over to the ENTRANCE HALL.

INT. BACKSTAGE - SAME TIME

The police officer pushes Erin behind the curtain of armed guards protecting the candidates and their entourage.

Henriette and Fields are in the middle of a heated discussion.

FIELDS

You have no idea what you are talking about, Henriette.

HENRIETTE

Do you think this is normal? Can't you hear the screams coming from the other side of the curtain?

FIELDS

They are afraid because you are playing boogeyman.

HENRIETTE

They are afraid because The fucking Puma is in this building and could kill us all if he wanted to.

ERIN

He is not in the building.

Everyone turns to Erin.

GEORGE

Erin?

HENRIETTE

La creme de la creme of this city out there screaming in fear, yet the intrepid journalist manages to sneak into the most secure area of the building.

ERIN

It wasn't really my call.

HENRIETTE

Is it ever?

Erin ignores the remark.

ERIN

There is no danger. He is not here.

FIELDS

Now, how would you know that? You heard what we heard, I assume.

ERIN

I don't know who did it or how, but it's just a ploy to terrify the city. There is no point in scaring the streets if City Hall sleeps comfortably.

HENRIETTE

Sounds like you know an awful lot about what's going on.

ERIN

I do and I don't. But I do know for sure that wasn't The Puma growling.

HENRIETTE

Because you know your boyfriend so well?

ERIN

Because I know where he is.

THE GROWL.

Screams are heard in the background, security draws their guns.

ERIN (CONT'D)

I'm getting out of here.

An officer grabs her wrist as she tries to leave. Erin turns to him with look of haughty disdain.

EXT. CITY HALL - SAME TIME

Police struggles to keep the crowd in check as they hear the screams coming out of city hall.

MAN #1

What's going on in there?

WOMAN #1

Is that him? Is that monster back?

JACK
Yes he is.

Behind her appears DiAngelo, struggling towards the police line.

JACK (CONT'D)
Now let me through.

A couple of officers see Jack and exit the line to escort him through.

OFFICER #1
Let him through!

OFFICER #2
Open up folks!

A small corridor opens, some folks remove their Puma masks as the officers walk through.

OFFICER #1
(under his breath)
Where were you Lieutenant?

JACK
It doesn't matter. Now I'm here.

OFFICER #2
What do we do?

JACK
We tear down that fucking net. I am not going to have an other Water Supply Massacre on my hands.

Jack walks through the terrified police line, turns to the other two officers.

JACK (CONT'D)
Evacuate the area. I need a perimeter, as wide as you possibly can. Then. I need medical to be set up as soon as possible. Then. I need guns on every surrounding building. I need SWAT teams. He is not getting out of here alive.

The officers nod and turn to pass on the instructions.

Jack walks up the stairs.

The sky rumbles.

The officers behind the net turn to him.

We hear more screaming inside.

GUNSHOTS.

The doors of city hall BUST open.

The elite of Derry City EXPLODES out of the building.

Officers draw their guns towards them.

STUART

Stay back! Stay the fuck back!

People scream in terror.

MAN #2

Let us out! He's in here!

WOMAN #2

We are all going to die.

JACK

Open the fucking the net!

As he finishes the sentence, more people spill out.

It's a STAMPEDE.

The officers are pushed against the steel net, people fall on top of them, shots go off.

BLOOD. SCREAMS.

JACK (CONT'D)

(to the top of the
building)

TEAR IT THE FUCK DOWN.

The officers on top of the building stumble to let the net loose.

More people spill outside.

JACK (CONT'D)

FUCKING NOW!

The net goes down.

The sound of it falling to the ground is UNBEARABLE.

It all goes SILENT and STIFF.

We see the debris growing from the marble stairs.

People are CRUSHED right under the net.

Corpses and injured ROLL down the stairs.

We see DiAngelo screaming for help to go in.

Medics and military rush to the building.

LEWIS (V.O.)

He seemed like such a good guy.
Better than most dudes I ever met-
but then-

INT. CITY HALL - CONTINUOUS

The SWAT team enters the building to find the remaining terrified people.

They scream orders.

People drop to the ground with their hands above their heads.

LEWIS (V.O.) (CONT'D)

-then he had to come knocking with
that bullshit about The Puma still
being out there.

EXT. CITY HALL - CONTINUOUS

Jack looks through the sea of bodies for Erin.

He proceeds towards the entrance of the building.

LEWIS (V.O.) (CONT'D)

-about The Puma taunting him with
those kids in the masks. They were
working for The Puma. Like I get
being mad at The Puma for what
happened. But those were kids he
was sending to the slaughter house.

EXT. CITY HALL - CONTINUOUS

Jack finds Dr. Cooper on the ground.

JACK

Doctor. Doctor. Erin. Where is she?

DR. PALMER

I- I don't know.

JACK
Are you okay?

DR. PALMER
This is carnage.

Jack continues the search.

LEWIS (V.O.) (CONT'D)
A couple of days later, a kid in a
Puma mask left that note. Hunt me.
And that's just what he did.

EXT. CITY HALL - SAME TIME

People screaming try to overcome the police perimeter. They
can barely see what happened.

MASHA (V.O.)
Who was it? Who told him that?

We go through some faces in the crowd.

Terrified man, women and children.

Until we settle on...

LEWIS (V.O.)
It was Josh Rein.

Josh looks at the scene from afar, then turns around and
seemingly leaves.

INT. TALK SHOW - DAY

Audrey Horne sits next to morning talk show host James
Bronstain (50's). James leans forward.

JAMES
How do you feel, Ms. Horne?

AUDREY
You can call me Audrey.

JAMES
Sure thing. How do you feel,
Audrey?

AUDREY
Well. I feel like every person in
this city feels after last night. I
feel scared. I feel powerless.
(MORE)

AUDREY (CONT'D)

I feel like the world is a darker place than it was yesterday, if that makes sense.

JAMES

Of course it makes sense. I'm guessing this was your first encounter with-

He clears his throat.

JAMES (CONT'D)

-With The Puma.

AUDREY

It was in fact. I- I am still kind of new here, you know. I just moved here from a small town in the state of Washington just short from a year ago- and now this. It's definitely a lot.

JAMES

I understand that. And- while of course a tragedy of catastrophic proportions transpired, with the twelve people losing their life and over sixty-five injured- you didn't actually get to see The Puma.

AUDREY

No one did apparently.

JAMES

Then how can we be sure it was actually him?

AUDREY

Have you heard it before?

JAMES

The Growl?

AUDREY

That monstrosity.

JAMES

I have to say that it a pretty common experience for Darrians to having being exposed to it on a number of occasions over the last ten years.

She smirks, tilts her head.

INT. LOBBY - RAIN PENTHOUSE - DAY

The doorman, Charlie, is watching the talk show on his phone at his desk.

George walks in. Charlie quickly shuts down his phone and forces a smile.

CHARLIE
Good morning, Mr. Harrison.

GEORGE
Good morning, Charlie.

George heads for the elevator and calls it.

CHARLIE
You were there right?

GEORGE
Sorry?

CHARLIE
You were at city hall last night.

GEORGE
Yes, Charlie.

CHARLIE
I think he did the right thing.

GEORGE
A lot of people died, Charlie.

CHARLIE
Those suits ain't people.

GEORGE
Am I not people?

CHARLIE
Are you just a suit?

The elevator reaches the lobby. George steps in.

CHARLIE (CONT'D)
Make sure to thank him for me.

GEORGE
Thank who?

Charlie bursts out laughing.

Elevator doors close.

INT. RAIN PENTHOUSE - MOMENTS LATER

Josh stares out the window over the cloudy city.

Elevator doors open behind him, he observes George stepping in the window reflection.

JOSH

I need to know why, George.

Josh turns around.

JOSH (CONT'D)

Why so blatant? Why the refusal to jump through any hoops? No precautions, no complex schemes. Do I not even get the dignity to be stabbed in the back? You chose to wield the dagger and push it right through my heart, just to come here and triumphantly stand over my agonising body.

George doesn't say anything, he heads for the kitchen.

George turns his shoulders to Josh and opens a cabinet to take out a glass.

He turns back to Josh and opens the tap.

George looks left and right without turning his head.

GEORGE

Are you done with your lunatic raving?

JOSH

George-

GEORGE

I don't even know what you are on about, young man. What the fuck were you doing growling through city hall last night?

JOSH

Come on. Don't do this. There is no need to resort to this shit. Who did you give the mask to? What did you say to Erin?

GEORGE

What?

JOSH

What I wholeheartedly cannot seem to get through my head is what is the endgame here. What do you actually gain from this? Sure- Henriette becomes mayor, but what does that do for you? What more political power could you need? For what purpose? I mean- there is one purpose I could see, but that would be insane. Even for you. Even for a man of such volatile morals and ethics.

GEORGE

Who did I give the mask-

JOSH

But even then- even accepting that you were indeed involved with my father- and god that makes me want to kill you right now- why go through the trouble of making Erin think I killed Masha? You want me to kill myself, don't you? You saw I was on the precipice, you saw just one feeble hand holding on to me with the tip of her fingers, and you said: fuck it. Let me go ahead and chop that hand right off. This is what happened, George? Isn't it? When are you going to go on TV and tell the world that the terrible Puma is non other than Josh Rein? That I ripped my dead's head off with my own hands? That I forced you to work for me, to aid me in my mischief just like Alexander Rein did? You are going to say that you had no choice, right? That all you could do was shut up and obey, because you have a family and I am a disgusting dangerous animal, just like my father.

GEORGE

Josh...

JOSH

Get the fuck out of my house. I don't ever want to see you again.

(MORE)

JOSH (CONT'D)
Ever. Or I swear to God I will
fucking kill you. I have nothing
else to lose. You succeeded.

GEORGE
I don't know what you think
happened, Josh. But how could you
even- you know that none of that is
true. You must know it.

JOSH
GET THE FUCK OUT!!!

George stiffens. He slowly closes the tap and without ever
turning to Josh leaves the penthouse.

As soon as the door closes, Josh turns and punches the
window with all his strength.

INT. ERIN'S APARTMENT - DAY

The blinds are completely shut.

Erin lies in bed catatonic, staring at ceiling.

Jack comes and lies next to her. He turns to her.

JACK
Baby.

She doesn't react.

JACK (CONT'D)
You need to tell me who he is.

She turns away.

JACK (CONT'D)
Why would you still protect him?
Wasn't last night enough? Weren't
the last ten years enough? This has
to end. I can bring it an end. I
just need to know who he is.

Erin gets out of bed.

JACK (CONT'D)
Where are you going?

Erin alts on her way to the bathroom.

ERIN
What happened to the girl?

Jack sits up.

JACK
What girl?

Erin considers.

ERIN
I'm not really sure.

She heads to the bathroom.